

by the server to the client before pinging. The server does not allocate the IP addresses in a sequence.

Using IPTABLES for simple internal network access

In a multi-client set-up, you may often need to provide protected network access to the VPN clients connecting to the server. There are two ways of doing this:

- Configure the default router of your organisation to send all traffic destined for VPN addresses (10.8.0.0/24 in our case) to the VPN server.
- Masquerade all the VPN traffic to originate from the VPN server's internal IP address (not the 10.8.0.1). In most cases, my clients have chosen to go for masquerading as they host their server in an external data centre and do not have control over the router. This can be done as follows:

```
root@vpn.unixclinic.net # iptables -t nat -A POSTROUTING -o eth0 -j MASQUERADE
```

I am assuming that the VPN server is connected to the internal network through the `eth0` interface.

Further, one of my clients had the requirement of forcing all port 80 traffic coming from the VPN clients to go through their Squid proxy. This can be achieved by following the simple IPTABLES rule:

```
root@vpn.unixclinic.net # iptables -t nat -A PREROUTING -i tun+ -p tcp --dport 80 -j REDIRECT --to-port 3128
```

Moving on

In this article we have looked at two very commonly used configurations for OpenVPN. I have used OpenVPN with various types of configurations such as authentication using a MySQL database, freeradius backends, PAM, etc. If time permits, I will try to cover these configurations in some future article. 

References

- OpenVPN documentation: <http://openvpn.org/index.php/open-source/documentation.html>
- OpenVPN FAQ: <http://openvpn.org/index.php/open-source/faq.html>
- OpenVPN articles: <http://openvpn.org/index.php/open-source/articles.html>
- The user-space VPN and OpenVPN: <http://openvpn.net/papers/BLUG-talk/index.html>

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